

Building India's Next Consumer Class

The Union Budget's focus on the poor, women, youth, and farmers will unlock India's hidden potential, charting its next phase of growth



INDIA IS ON the path to becoming the third-largest economy by 2027,

surpassing developed nations such as Japan and Germany. Jefferies forecasts India's GDP to reach \$5 trillion within the next four years and estimates the country will edge closer to \$10 trillion by 2030. With the mandate set by the General Elections earlier this year, all eyes were on the government to see how it would set the stage to push India towards the next chapter—towards 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047.

The Union Budget 2024-25, presented by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, has provided some concrete steps to bolster India's economy through its focussed nine priority areas, which address the four key pillars of India: Poor, Women, Youth, and Farmers. With this, the government has outlined a comprehensive framework to foster economic growth, enhance social welfare, and bolster infrastructure development. The India@100 vision aims to turn the country into a much stronger, more resilient, and inclusive economic superpower.



BY SAUGATA GUPTA

A BUDGET FOR RURAL INDIA

India's rural markets have demonstrated resilience and continue to represent a considerable long-term growth opportunity. Hence, rural development and agricultural enhancement were expected to be high on the priority list. The immediate focus on building resilience and productivity in the agricultural segment is extremely crucial and would be highly beneficial when implemented effectively. With ₹1.52 lakh crore set aside for agriculture and allied sectors, this Budget showcases the government's intent to support farmers while ensuring that the country is more *atmanirbhar*. It also highlights the need for self-sufficiency in pulses and oilseeds, working towards strengthening their production, storage, and marketing. The initiative of training and certifying 10 million farmers in natural farming and establishing 10,000 need-based bio-input resource centres is a concrete step towards building a sustainable Bharat.

The recent introduction of 109 high-yielding, climate-resilient seed varieties indicates a significant advancement, poised to mitigate production volatility in the medium term. This development is particularly vital given the rise in adverse

THE ALLOCATION OF FUNDS FOR RURAL DEVELOPMENT WILL SPUR RURAL DEMAND... BOOSTING CONSUMPTION IN NON-METRO MARKETS